

Mozart's personality, warped by the adulation he had received as a child, lacked the balance and elevated qualities found in his music. He indulged an earthy taste for young women and his letters display a scatological sense of humor. He was tactlessly arrogant and never troubled to conceal his sense of superiority. Being treated as a paid servant—the effective status of a musician at that time—made him furious. In 1781, after a row with a Salzburg court official and Mozart's subsequent dismissal with an undignified kick in the behind for his insolence, he decided to try to make his living in Vienna as a freelance composer, piano performer, and music teacher.

Marriage and finances

Having lost his regular income, Mozart compounded his financial worries by marrying a woman without money. He had been pursuing Aloysia Weber, a soprano who was the daughter of a poor bass player. When she jilted him, he turned his attention to her younger sister Constanze. Under pressure from the Weber family, who threatened him with legal action, in 1782 he formalized the liaison. Children soon followed—Constanze eventually bore six offspring, of whom two survived infancy. The marriage was a success emotionally but placed demands on Mozart's finances that were often hard to meet.